Staff answers for causes and evidence

Tuesday 5 January 2027 | P2 | 40 minutes | Year A

Humanities | LAUNCH | Spring 1 Week 1 | HUM-LAUNCH-S1-W01

Use these answers to judge the learner's reasoning, not to require a single memorised paragraph. Keep actual pupil responses and help separate from the teacher-written model.

Source checks and causal links

S1, 28 June 1919: the Treaty of Versailles restricted armed forces, removed territory and imposed reparations. Nazi leaders exploited resentment. This is a background condition that helped political mobilisation; it cannot alone explain Nazi decisions or why war began in September 1939.

S2, 30 January 1933 and after: Hitler was appointed chancellor. The Nazis dismantled democracy, pursued territorial expansion and rebuilt military power. Their aims and decisions are a major driving cause. Do not generalise responsibility to every German person.

S3, September 1938 to March 1939: Britain and France hoped concessions at Munich would prevent conflict. German occupation of the Czech lands showed expansion continued. This supports a claim that appeasement failed to stop aggression. The policy response does not excuse or transfer responsibility for Nazi aggression.

S4: Germany invaded Poland on 1 September 1939. Britain and France declared war on 3 September after Germany did not withdraw. The invasion is the immediate trigger for the wider European war. The declarations help explain its widening, not an excuse for the invasion.

S5, optional: the German-Soviet Pact of 23 August 1939 reduced the immediate risk of Soviet opposition to an attack on Poland. It is an enabling factor. The two states did not share every aim. Do not call this pact the only cause.

Illustrative model

Illustrative teacher-written model explanation. Attributed to no real person.

Nazi expansion was a major cause of the Second World War in Europe. S2 shows that Nazi leaders sought territory and rebuilt armed forces after 1933. This increased the danger because they could use force against other countries. The Munich concessions did not stop expansion: S3 records occupation of the Czech lands in March 1939. The invasion of Poland on 1 September 1939 was the immediate trigger, followed by British and French declarations of war on 3 September (S4). Several causes mattered. These events did not make war unavoidable or justify aggression.

Checks feedback and historical boundaries

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Hinge and parallel check

Which answer explains a cause? A: The treaty was signed in 1919. B: Nazi leaders exploited resentment of the treaty to gain support for expansion, increasing the risk of conflict. C: The treaty made war certain.

B. A gives a fact without a causal link. C claims inevitability without evidence.

Check each learner privately. If either gives A or C, model fact plus because plus effect using S2, then use the parallel check before independent work.

S3 says German forces occupied Czech lands in March 1939. Explain what this suggests about the attempt to stop expansion through concessions. Answer: further expansion shows those concessions had not stopped aggression.

Likely errors and corrections

A list of dates is chronology. Ask how the decision changed the risk of war. A defensible explanation needs a supported because link. If a learner says the treaty made war certain, return to later decisions and alternatives. If a learner says Hitler was elected dictator, clarify his appointment as chancellor and the later dismantling of democracy.

If blame falls on Jewish people or all Germans, stop and correct the claim. Jewish people did not cause the war. Identify specific governments, leaders, policies and actions. Separate explaining causes from approving them. War in Asia predated September 1939, so keep the European scope explicit.

Judging the common finish

Across all routes, accept two accurate causes with dated evidence/source codes, an explanation of how each raised risk and the invasion of Poland as immediate trigger. Supported work can use exact directed pointing or scribing. Independent work can connect factors. Aspire adds a reasoned importance judgement, interaction or evidence limitation. Do not reward length without reasoning or infer independent reading from an adult-read source.

Sensitive response and evidence

Use the agreed private pause and supervised re-entry route. No graphic detail or historical simulation is needed. Distinguish the Holocaust from the wider war and recognise Jewish lives beyond victimhood. No pupil needs to share a personal connection. Follow existing safeguarding arrangements for a disclosure without public probing.

Offer to the Communication portfolio. Retain the learner’s own voice and an actual adult audience reply, one NS and the learner’s response in the same colour, on the same page or usual mode before recording R. Record E only after actual evidence banking. Record the actual response mode and help. A partner’s answer does not establish both learners’ understanding.

Research basis

Historical summaries draw on The National Archives, The Treaty of Versailles, and United States Holocaust Memorial Museum Holocaust Encyclopedia articles: Treaty of Versailles; Adolf Hitler is Appointed Chancellor; World War II in Europe; German Prewar Expansion; Munich Agreement; Invasion of Poland, Fall 1939; German-Soviet Pact. Teaching approach draws on United States Holocaust Memorial Museum Guidelines for Teaching about the Holocaust. Institution and title references identify the research without website addresses or copied archive text.